

Beyond the Scoreboard

By: Lizzie McGlynn

As I pen these lines, my heart feels the strain,
Three and a half years since life dealt its pain.

Since that cruel twist, you were taken away,
A car crash, abrupt, on a dark, fateful day.

Despite life's curveballs, you were meant to be near,
Dribbling, shooting hoops, without a fear.

Four years have passed, leaving a gap so wide,
Without you courtside, by our side.

You missed the college court, the game's embrace,
The chance to rise, to find your place.

Oh, the victories you never got to score,
Cut short, before you could explore.

I could've pictured you receiving that degree,
The one your college bestowed, for all at your funeral to see.

I could've pictured you soaring, a basketball star,
Your name in lights, known near and far.

You had a heart that knew no bounds,
Welcoming all, with love that resounds.

Your essence stayed strong, untouched by rank,
In high school, you were known, no blank.

Popular or geek, you welcomed with cheer,
A teammate to all, without any fear.

Your squad embraced all, without any fuss,
In your team, everyone found trust.

Labels meant nothing on the court, you knew,
Caring for all, a rare trait in you.

In my heart, your memory's embrace,

Your smile lighting up every space.

"I love you"s, a familiar sound,
Playful antics, joy all around.

By my side, when lunchtime came, you'd linger near,
Never leaving me in solitude, eliminating any fear.

Teacher's favorite, effortlessly,
These cherished moments will last eternally.

In essence, I believe you're watching over me,
Guiding me as you would if you were here, I see.

Your cheers echo through my life, ever true,
Just like the day I received the Pinnacle Award, with you.

Your voice, the loudest, amidst the crowd's roar,
I can still hear it now, as it was before.

Your legacy down here, truly divine,
Our high school honors you with a scholarship, a sign.

In the hearts of our class, you forever reside,
Parker, your memory, a beacon, changing lives worldwide.